

• FREE CHECKLIST

LinkedIn and Cover Letter Humanizing Checklist

Started with an AI draft? Here is how to make your posts and cover letters sound like you, with before-and-after examples and a 15-point checklist.

Why generic drafts cost you

Using AI to get a first draft is normal now. The problem is not the tool. The problem is that everybody's first draft sounds the same.

How common is it? Originality.ai, a company that sells an AI detector, has been tracking public LinkedIn posts of 100 words or more. In late 2024, after analysing 8,795 posts published since January 2018, it estimated that over half of recent long posts were likely AI-generated. In a July 2026 sample of 5,000 public posts, it put the figure at 81%. Treat these as one company's estimates, made with its own detector (and detectors make mistakes, as our other guides explain), not as precise facts. But anyone who scrolls LinkedIn will recognise the picture: many posts with the same hooks, the same rhythm and the same lessons.

For you, that means two risks:

- **You blend in.** A recruiter reading a pile of cover letters remembers the one with a real detail, not the one that is "passionate about driving impactful results."
- **You lose trust.** When a post or letter reads like a template, readers wonder what else is not really you. That matters more than any detector score.

The fix takes 10 to 15 minutes per piece. You keep the speed of the draft and add the one thing a model cannot supply: you.

The tells that make text read as AI

None of these is wrong on its own. Together, they make text sound generic. Many of them are also among the patterns our free detector looks for.

In LinkedIn posts

Tell	Typical example	What to do instead
The announcement opener	"I'm thrilled to announce..." / "I'm humbled and honored..."	Start with the thing itself: what happened, in one plain sentence.
Stock casual hooks	"Here's the thing." "Let's be honest." "Let that sink in."	Open with a specific moment, number or question you actually had.
A stack of one-line paragraphs	Twelve lines of one sentence each, every post.	Mix short lines with a normal paragraph or two.
"It's not just X, it's Y"	"It's not just a job. It's a calling."	Say what it is, once.
Everything in threes	"Grit, growth, and gratitude."	Use the number of items that is true.

Tell	Typical example	What to do instead
The generic lesson	"Consistency is key." "Never stop learning."	Give the specific lesson only this experience taught you.
Corporate vocabulary	leverage, synergy, game-changing, robust, ecosystem, stakeholders	Use the words you would say to a colleague over coffee.
Vague proof	"Studies show..." "Experts agree..."	Name the source, or share your own numbers.
The engagement-bait ending	"Agree?" "Thoughts?" plus ten hashtags	Ask a real, narrow question, or just end. A couple of relevant hashtags is plenty.
Perfect, even rhythm	Every sentence 15 to 20 words, every paragraph the same size.	Read it aloud. Break one sentence. Let one run long.

In cover letters

Tell	Typical example	What to do instead
The formal opener	"I am writing to express my keen interest in the position of..."	Open with why this company, or with your most relevant result.
Self-description without proof	"a highly motivated, detail-oriented professional with a proven track record"	Delete the adjectives. Add one result with a number.
The job ad, repeated back	Listing the requirements and saying you meet each one.	Pick the two that matter most and prove them with stories.
"Dynamic, fast-paced environment"	Phrases that could describe any company.	Mention something specific: a product, a recent launch, a value you saw in action.
"My skills align perfectly"	Claims of perfect fit.	Show the fit with an example. Let the reader decide.
AI favourite words	leverage, spearhead, pivotal, seamless, passionate, transformative	Plain verbs: built, fixed, led, cut, grew, wrote.
The generic close	"I am confident I would be a valuable asset to your team."	Close with a specific next step or one line about what you would do first.

Before and after: a LinkedIn post

EXAMPLE

Before (typical AI draft):

"I'm thrilled to announce that I've completed my Google Data Analytics Certificate! [party emoji]

This journey has been nothing short of transformative. It's not just about learning tools, it's about developing a data-driven mindset.

Here are 3 key takeaways: 1. Consistency is key 2. Never stop learning 3. Data tells a story

I'm grateful for everyone who supported me along the way. Excited for what the future holds!

Agree? [pointing emoji] #DataAnalytics #Growth #Learning #CareerGrowth #Motivation"

EXAMPLE

After (same news, a real person):

"I finished the Google Data Analytics Certificate last night, about five months after I started it on my lunch breaks.

The part I nearly quit on was SQL joins. What finally made them click was rebuilding our shop's monthly stock report from scratch. It used to take me a full afternoon in Excel. The query version takes four minutes, and it found two suppliers we were double-counting.

I'm now looking for a junior analyst role in Tunis or remote. If your team works with messy retail data, I would love to hear what your first week looks like.

#DataAnalytics #SQL"

What changed: a real timeline, one honest struggle, one concrete result with numbers, a clear ask, two relevant hashtags. No "thrilled," no "journey," no list of lessons anyone could write.

Before and after: a cover-letter paragraph

EXAMPLE

Before (typical AI draft):

"I am writing to express my keen interest in the Marketing Coordinator position at Brightline. As a highly motivated and detail-oriented professional with a proven track record in digital marketing, I am confident that my skills align perfectly with your requirements. I thrive in dynamic, fast-paced environments and am passionate about leveraging data-driven strategies to deliver impactful results."

EXAMPLE

After (same person, specific):

"Last spring I ran the newsletter for a 12-person bakery chain with no budget and an email list of 900 people. By switching from monthly promotions to a short weekly 'what's fresh' note, I raised the open rate from 18% to 41% in three months, and our Saturday pre-orders doubled. Brightline's move into local delivery partnerships is the kind of work where I'd like to do that again, at a bigger scale."

What changed: the adjectives are gone. In their place are a situation, an action, numbers and a reason for choosing this company. The second version is shorter to read and much harder to forget.

WATCH OUT

Every detail in your letter must be true. Do not let an AI tool invent numbers, titles or results to make an "after" version sound better. Recruiters check, and interviews will test it.

The 15-point checklist

Use it on any AI-assisted post, cover letter, email or bio before you send it.

Substance

- ☐ **1. One real detail per paragraph.** A name, a number, a date, a place, a tool, a quote.
- ☐ **2. At least one result with a number** (time saved, people helped, money, growth, ranking).
- ☐ **3. Something only you could write.** A moment, a mistake, a decision, an opinion.
- ☐ **4. Every fact is true and checked.** Dates, titles, numbers, company names.
- ☐ **5. Company-specific (cover letters).** You mention something real about this company, not something that fits any company.

Language

- ☐ **6. No announcement or formal openers.** No "I'm thrilled to announce" or "I am writing to express my interest."
- ☐ **7. Buzzwords removed.** Search for leverage, passionate, dynamic, transformative, seamless, spearhead, synergy, game-changing. Keep one at most, if it is truly the right word.
- ☐ **8. No "it's not just X, it's Y."**
- ☐ **9. No vague proof.** Replace "studies show" and "experts agree" with a named source or your own experience.
- ☐ **10. Words you would actually say.** Read it aloud. Rewrite any line you would not say to a colleague.

Shape and rhythm

- ☐ **11. Varied sentence length.** At least one short sentence. At least one longer one.
- ☐ **12. Lists only for real lists.** Not every idea in threes, not every post as bullet points.
- ☐ **13. Paragraphs of different sizes.** Not twelve one-line paragraphs in a row.
- ☐ **14. A real ending.** A specific question, a clear ask, or simply stop. No "Agree?" and no hashtag wall.

Final check

- ☐ **15. The "would my friend recognise me?" test.** Show it to someone who knows you, or read it back tomorrow morning. If it does not sound like you, change the lines that don't.

PRO TIP

Speed trick: keep a small "me file". A note with your real numbers, stories, projects and phrases you actually use. When you get an AI draft, replace its generic claims with items from that file. Ten minutes, and the draft becomes yours.

Using AI drafts honestly at work

- **Know the rules.** Some employers, clients and application forms ask whether AI was used. Answer truthfully.
- **Own every word.** If your name is on it, you are responsible for it. Check facts, numbers and claims yourself.
- **Never invent experience.** An AI tool will happily add a "proven track record" you do not have. Delete it.
- **A detector score is not the goal.** The goal is a post or letter that is true, specific and sounds like you. A reader cares about that far more than any tool.

Check your own text free

Want a second opinion on your draft?

- **Free AI detector:** humanizeit.app/ai-detector. Paste your post or letter and see which phrases and patterns make it read as generic AI text, line by line. No signup.
- **Free humanizer:** humanizeit.app/free-ai-humanizer. A quick way to loosen stiff, formal wording. Then add your own details from the checklist above, because no tool knows your story.

No tool can guarantee how a reader or another detector will judge your text. Your details and your voice are what make it work.

Sources

- The Register, "Half of LinkedIn thought leaders are writing content with AI" (28 Nov 2024), reporting Originality.ai's analysis of 8,795 long-form LinkedIn posts (January 2018 to October 2024): https://www.theregister.com/2024/11/28/linkedin_ai_posts
- Originality.ai, LinkedIn AI content study (continuing study; July 2026 update: 5,000 public posts of 100+ words, 81.2% classified "Likely AI" by its own detector): <https://originality.ai/blog/ai-content-published-linkedin>

- The "tells" in this checklist are editorial observations, cross-checked against the pattern list used by Humanizeit's open detector (<https://humanizeit.app/ai-detector>). They are not a scientific measure of AI use.
- Before-and-after examples were written for this guide. Names and numbers in them are illustrative.